

### 1. Quoting Terence Tao

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-09T00:20:17+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/9/terence-tao/>

I wrote recently about how the collection of good, fruitful open problems is now being mined in a non-renewable fashion, leading to the potential scenario of these problems becoming scarce. [...] We have now seen that even the rumor of someone working on a problem can trigger a massive amount of AI-powered effort to flatten it before the original research project has time to reach its full potential. The incentives may now be pointing in the direction of no longer sharing any promising research directions with the broader community, which would reverse centuries of traditions of open science and do serious long-term damage to the future of the field. ? Terence Tao Tags: ai-ethics , mathematics , ai

### 2. On the Navier-Stokes Millennium Prize Problem

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-08T23:55:12+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/8/on-navier-stokes/>

On the Navier-Stokes Millennium Prize Problem Impressive result from OpenAI, who used an unreleased model to produce a resolution to the Navier-Stokes existence and smoothness problem, one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems that have been subject to a \$1,000,000 prize since May 24th, 2000. The discovery is somewhat overshadowed by accusations of skulduggery from Tristan Buckmaster, an NYU mathematics professor who was collaborating on related problems with Levent Alpoge, an accomplished mathematician who currently works for Anthropic. Tristan's complaint accompanied a hastily published version of their own results. Here's the PDF describing what happened. The very short version is that Tristan and Levent worked on the problem for almost a year, making extensive use of Claude and Codex (mainly GPT-5.6 Sol), then had a breakthrough on August 15th. The mathematical rumour mill kicked into gear and Tristan and Levent heard that OpenAI had heard that Anthropic had resolved "a major open problem", so they reached out and learned that OpenAI had a team working on a related problem, with a similar approach. Quoting Tristan: I asked when the first prompt had been sent by them. This q...

### 3. Introducing ChatGPT Images 2.5

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-08T22:46:33+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/8/introducing-chatgpt-images-25/>

Introducing ChatGPT Images 2.5 OpenAI's image generation models are apparently used "more than 3 billion images across ChatGPT Images and the GPT-4 Image models in the API". This latest release improves their instruction-following ability across multiple turns, responds faster, and "is better at preserving the subjects in your reference photos". There are two new model IDs in the API: gpt-image-2.5-sunburst and gpt-image-2.5-flare. Based on this I think Sunburst is the stronger option: Choose Sunburst for workflows where editing precision matters most, and Flare for fast, high-quality everyday image generation. I upgraded my openai\_image.py CLI tool to support passing in one or more reference images, so now this works: `uv run https://tools.simonwillison.net/python/openai_image.py \ ' add a raccoon scientist studying the chart thoughtfully ' \ -i https://static.simonwillison.net/static/2026/openai-agent-usage.webp \ -m gpt-image-2.5-sunburst` This is the original image, and here's what I got back from that prompt to "add a raccoon scientist studying the chart thoughtfully": Tags: tools , ai , openai , generative-ai , uv , text-to-image

### 4. OpenNMC is an open replacement for expensive APC management cards

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 11:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/opennmc-apc-ups-replacement-card/>

UPSes are typically the most boring part of your homelab, but they're important. One of their main jobs is to give servers time to shut down safely if the power goes out. Another job is to

condition your power so your servers can run smoothly. To do both of those things well , you need a smart interface. And at least with APC, there are tons of older UPSes that use Network Management Cards. The one pictured below is the NMC 2, and I pulled out of my old APC Smart-UPS 2200 XL (pictured above).

#### 5. Microsoft Plugs Nearly 1,000 Security Holes

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 21:44:22 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/09/microsoft-plugs-nearly-1000-security-holes/>  
Microsoft Corp. today issued updates to plug at least 974 security holes in its Windows operating systems and other software, by far its biggest single patch batch ever. Microsoft says artificial intelligence is helping to speed the discovery of vulnerabilities, but security experts warn that many organizations already are struggling to prioritize the more human-intensive endeavor of testing and deploying so many fixes each month.

#### 6. ? The iPhone Air and iPhone 17 Pro

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-09T00:55:53Z

Link: [https://daringfireball.net/2026/09/the\\_iphone\\_air\\_and\\_iphone\\_17\\_pro](https://daringfireball.net/2026/09/the_iphone_air_and_iphone_17_pro)

One year later and it feels like both the iPhone 17 Pro and iPhone Air could be announced tomorrow, not a year ago, and would seem fresh and exciting.

#### 7. ?Modern Day Typographer?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-08T22:57:00Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0Ck-NPqf2c8>

There are good Elle Cordova videos, and there are great ones. ( Last mentioned here for her ? Fonts Hanging Out ? trilogy.) ?

#### 8. ? SuperDuper 4

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-08T14:55:20Z

Link: [https://daringfireball.net/2026/09/superduper\\_4](https://daringfireball.net/2026/09/superduper_4)

SuperDuper feels like impossibly good software.

#### 9. A sample use of the winstart.bat file in Windows 95

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260908-00/?p=112679>

For a driver that needs high resolution mode only in Windows. The post A sample use of the winstart.bat file in Windows 95 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

#### 10. Why don't we allow stacks to be sparse, instead of forcing them to be contiguous?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 07 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260907-00/?p=112677>

Imagining how to report a memory allocation failure for a sparse page. The post Why don't we allow stacks to be sparse, instead of forcing them to be contiguous? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

#### 11. Navier-Stokes in the news

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 15:26:08 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/08/navier-stokes-in-the-news/>

There are rumors that a long-standing math problem, one of the Millennium Prize problems, has been solved. The problem concerns technical properties of solutions to the Navier-Stokes equations [1], a set of equations that describe the dynamics of fluid flow. Popular accounts of the problem are often oversimplified and misleading. Some reports will speak of [?] The post Navier-Stokes in the news first appeared on John D. Cook .

#### 12. ActivityPub - Is it worth defending against replay attacks and message/signature time skew?

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 11:34:51 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/activitypub-is-it-worth-defending-against-replay-attacks-and-message-signature-time-skew/>

Here's a problem that I've found with ActivityBot - my little ActivityPub server. Sometimes it receives messages which were originally sent months ago. Why does that happen and is it risky to accept and process them? My tl;dr is that it probably isn't worth worrying about. But I'd love someone to tell me why I'm wrong. Here's my thinking: [Table of Contents](#) Causes Is that a problem? What are we?

### 13. What's new in git-pkgs

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-09-08T09:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/09/08/whats-new-in-git-pkgs.html>

I'm on holiday this week, so here's a listicle. Back in February I wrote up the fourteen Go modules behind git-pkgs, a git subcommand for exploring dependency history. The org now has around forty-five repositories: ten standalone tools, around thirty library modules, and the GitHub Actions and agent skills that wire them into CI and coding assistants. Several of the tools have had their own posts here already ( [brief](#) , [proxy](#) , [forge](#) , [actions](#) ), so for those I'll cover what's changed since. Tools git-pkgs The main CLI has gone from v0.14 to v0.20 and added eight new subcommands: [git pkgs changelog](#) fetches the upstream changelog and shows entries between two versions [git pkgs freshness](#) reports how many days behind the latest release each dependency is [git pkgs deprecated](#) checks installed versions against registry deprecation flags [git pkgs funding](#) lists sponsorship links for your dependencies, with `--missing` to invert [git pkgs maintainers](#) reports maintainer counts and names, with `--single` to find one-person projects [git pkgs health](#) scores each dependency's project against [ecosyste.ms](#) metadata [git pkgs provenance](#) reports registry attestations and trusted-publishing status for npm,...

### 14. Concentration Risk

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 14:28:03 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/concentration-risk/>

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### 15. Pretraining progress is mostly coming from data

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 16:10:16 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/pretraining-progress-is-mostly-data>

Breaking down 6 years of pretraining progress into data vs model improvements

### 16. The Bulldozing of an Interface

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Tue, 08 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/bulldoze-ui/>

Marcin Wichary has a lovely article titled "Photoshop's challenges with focus, pt. 2". If you're into the minutiae of interface design, this is a good read. It perfectly illustrates how impossible it is to try and compare two interfaces side by side as static images. What matters in an interface is how it works, i.e. how you interface with it. And when you bulldoze an interface to build a new one, comparing the old vs. new side-by-side to make sure you've captured everything is a lie. It's never obvious what has been lost because the interactive pieces are missing from the static images, and those are what matter most because it's how the feature works! I've found this to be true a lot as of late. Lots of tiny details that were meticulously crafted over years with specific rationales tied to real-world use cases, all completely bulldozed in a giant refactor. (All made possible by the great omniscient power of AI.) Few notice what's gone because few can see what's being lost in the first place. Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky